

have \$12K in debt! Your choices led to your debt—the many choices to buy on credit over paying cash. You chose to buy those hideous clothes in the closet. You chose the fancy car. You chose to run with the Joneses. Or perhaps you live in a house that’s just too expensive and you have paid for everyday staples like groceries using your credit card. Escaping credit card debt requires a commitment to process over event, except in the reverse. Repent from the Sidewalk and make new choices that are designed to keep your debt from growing, or better, to get it declining. Pay cash for everything. If you can’t pay cash, you can’t afford it.

Second, focus on your income. Face it. You need to make more money. If you owned a business that profited \$15,000 every single month, would that debt suddenly seem like such a burden? No, it wouldn’t. You’d have it paid off in weeks, not decades. *Income is the answer*, with a temporary mandate at expense reduction to curb debt growth.

Commit to starting a need-based business that you can use to expand income and expose yourself to the Fastlane wealth equation. Yes, you might need to get your hands dirty doing something that most others would find repulsive. You will need to do what most others won’t. You either want it badly enough, or not at all.

MJ, my wife and I are traveling two different roads. She is a lifelong Slowlaner consumed with saving every dime and living a life of frugality, and I am a serial entrepreneur who wants a little more from life. My problem is my “serialness” hasn’t produced any success other than turmoil in my relationship.

Has your wife read this book? If so, and she doesn’t agree with Fastlane philosophy nor want to participate, you might have tough decisions to make in your future. Your spouse is your lifelong partner, and if your roads don’t run parallel, it could be rough riding ahead. Like our choices and their horsepower, relationships also have trajectory. Today’s road that diverges one degree from your partner’s road will be divergent 90 degrees years from now.

Personally, I’m not interested in relationships that are “good enough” but relationships that empower both individuals to be the best they can be. I can’t speculate on the strength of your relationship; only you can do that. Can you and your spouse compromise on some common tenets that can bridge your divide of philosophy? Like the value of time? Like the importance of financial literacy? Like the need to divorce your income from time? Like the ruinous effects of parasitic debt? Perhaps these common grounds are strong enough to keep your roads bound together for a common goal.

And finally, your “serialness” might be a problem. Are you a polygamist opportunist balancing 10 different opportunities? Your business is a spouse. Quit cheating and give one business all of your attention. You will get out what you put in, and rationing your time among mistresses is a slow prescription to lackluster incomes and asset values.